Understanding Regional Ecosystems for Innovation: the case of the circular economy

Inês Campelo
Department Economic Geography
Faculty of Spatial Sciences, University of Groningen

PhD Trajectory

How do EU-funded policies and programs influence the structure and evolution of regional innovation ecosystems, and under what conditions do these ecosystems contribute to the transition to a circular economy (CE)?

Conceptual Relationships

Regional characteristics

- Development stage
- Geography
- Population education levels

+

EU Support

EU Funding and EU Co-Financing

→

Position in EU (Collaboration) Networks

Conceptual Relationships

Regional characteristics

- Development stage
- Geography
- Population education levels

+

Ecosystem Governance structure

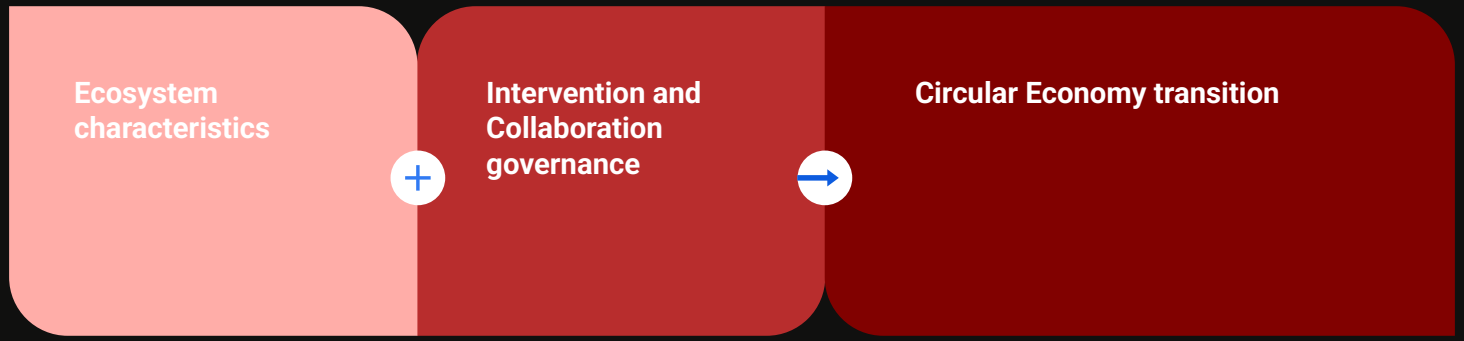
Governance

→

Circular Economy Ecosystem

Inês Campelo, University of Groningen

Conceptual Relationships



Conceptual Relationships

Regional characteristics

- Development stage
- Geography
- Population education levels

+

Mission-oriented approach

→

Interregional Collaboration in EU

PhD Trajectory

- Patterns of interregional in the EU / Who is collaborating with who?
- Circular Economy / How to balance dual logic of Circular Ecosystems?
- EU-funded initiatives and their contribution to CE and Cohesion Policy / How do regions collaborate and how is that contributing towards transition to a Circular Economy?
- Organizational structures of intra-regional collaboration/cooperation / How is mission-oriented approach shaping/influencing collaboration?

Ideas & Directions

Inês Campelo, University of Groningen
22nd April, International PhD Course on Economic Geography

Patterns of Interregional Collaboration across the EU

Inês Campelo
Department Economic Geography
Faculty of Spatial Sciences, University of Groningen

Interregional Collaboration across the EU – Why study this?

A look into where different regions stand when it comes to EU Cohesion Policy and funding for innovation

- **⅓ of EU Budget goes to EU Cohesion Policy**
- European Regional Development Fund is the main source of funding of Innovation
  - Management shared between the Commission and the Regional or national authorities.
- How are these funds used? How are regions leveraging these funds?
- New approach: Networks created by these programs

Inês Campelo, University of Groningen
22nd April, International PhD Course on Economic Geography

Interregional Collaboration across the EU

EU Interregional Collaborations

Regional Characteristics

Periphery or central region?

More developed or less developed?

Collaboration Patterns

What sort of patterns are created?

Convergence or divergence across EU regions?

EU Co-Financing

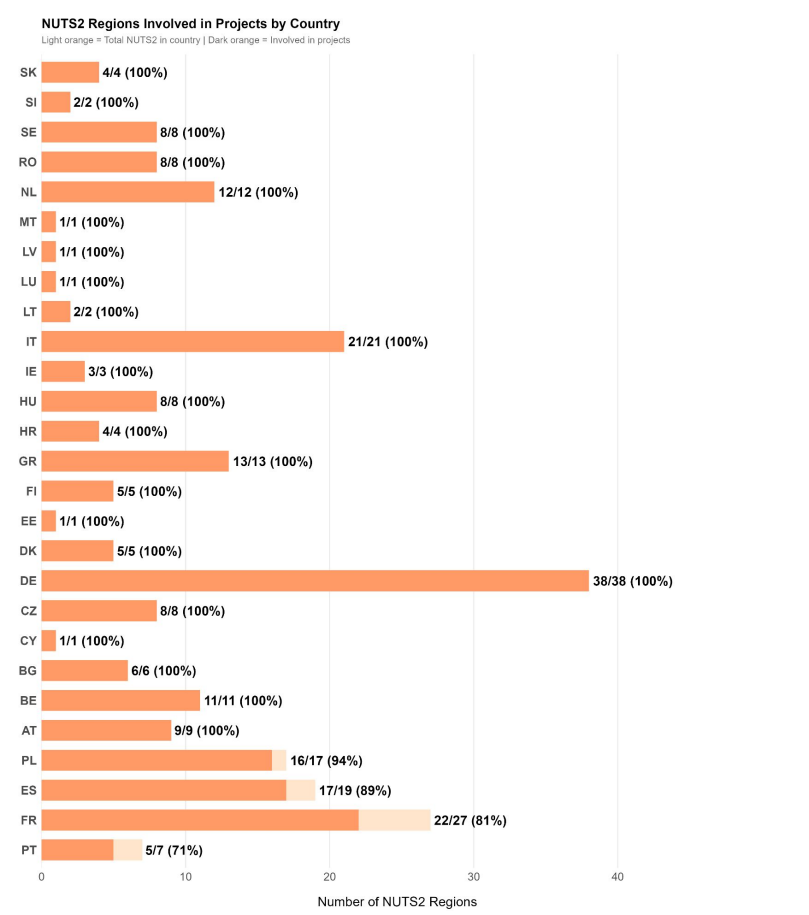
Is EU Co-Financing compensating for less developed regions?

Research Question: Who works with who?

Sub-Research Questions:

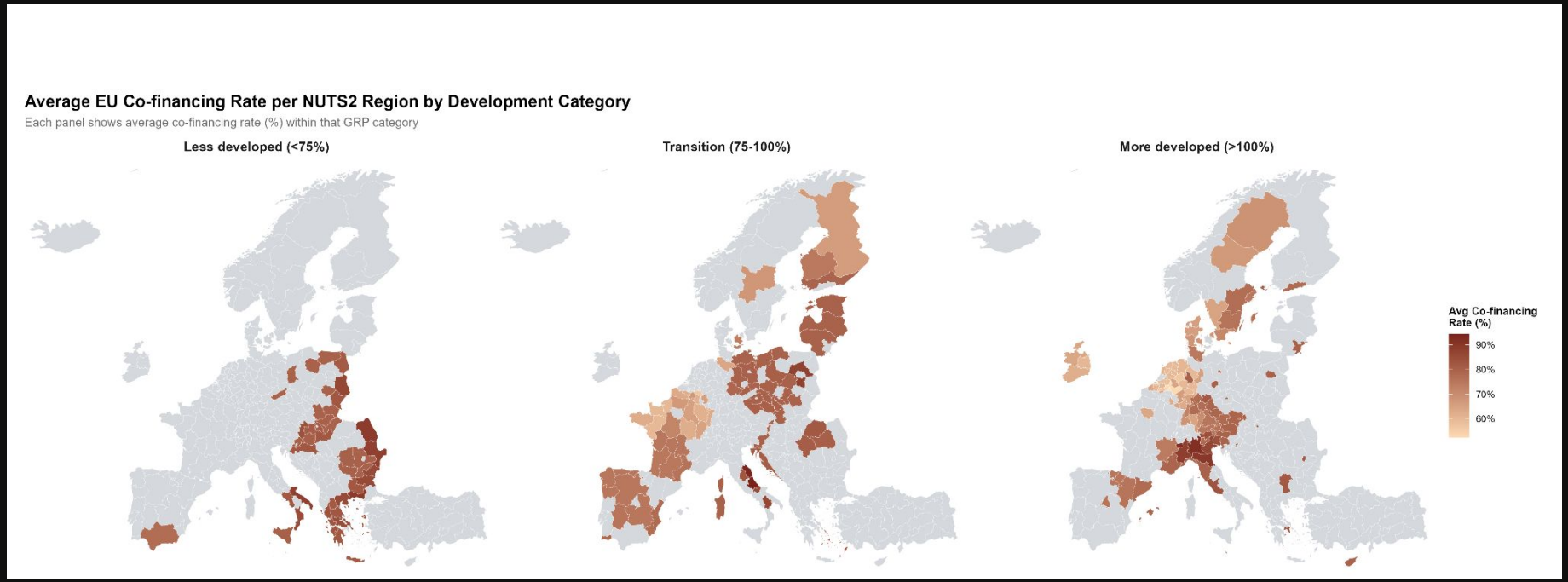
- How are different types of regions (central vs. peripheral and less developed vs. developed) represented? Which regions participate in EU interregional collaboration programs?
- What patterns of interregional collaboration exist across EU regions?
- How are regions leveraging EU co-financing rates in these programs?

Sample (2021–2027)



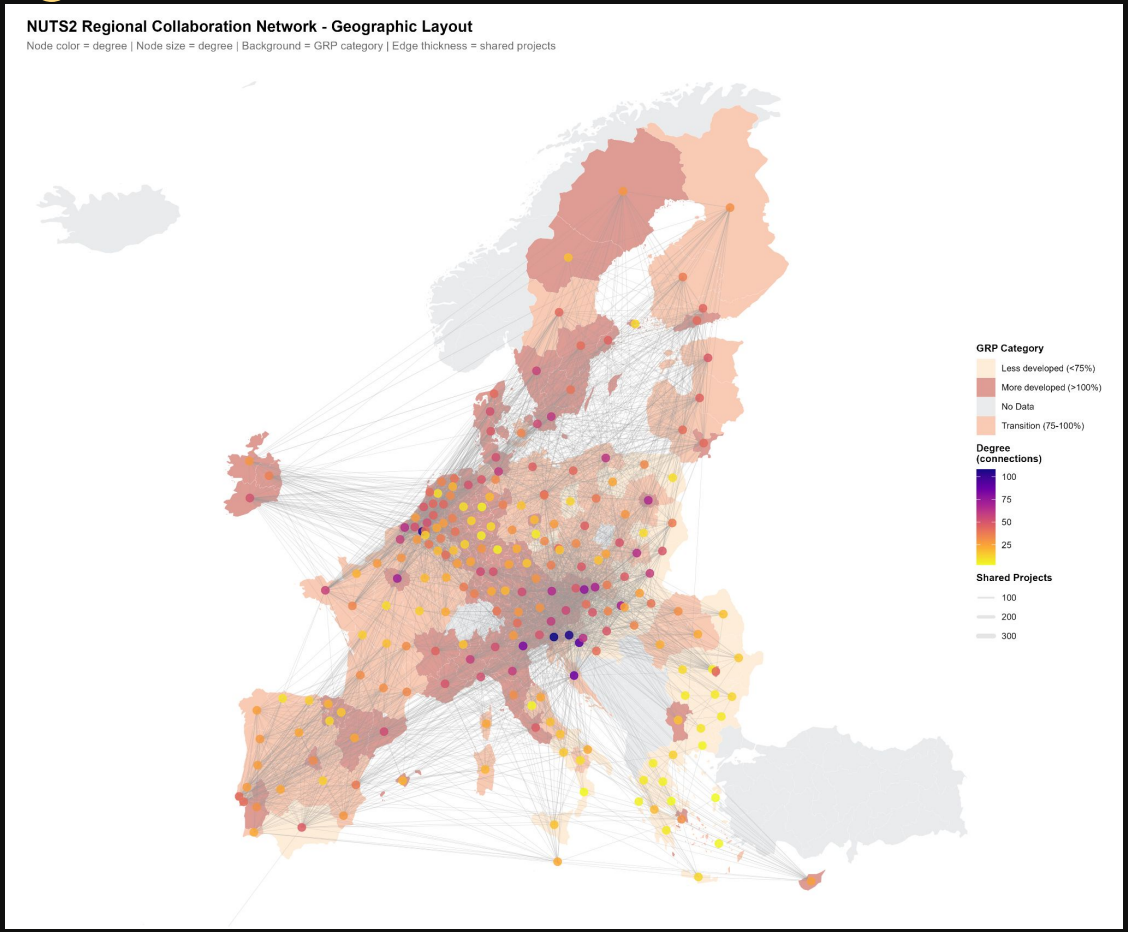
Inês Campelo, University of Groningen
22nd April, International PhD Course on Economic Geography

Geography of EU Co-Financing (2021–2027)



Inês Campelo, University of Groningen
22nd April, International PhD Course on Economic Geography

Patterns of Interregional Collaboration across the EU



Inês Campelo, University of Groningen
22nd April, International PhD Course on Economic Geography

Future Directions

What influences the region's position in the network?

Compare across different periods (collaboration network, co-financing rates, position)

Compare across different types of programs, such as R&D programs